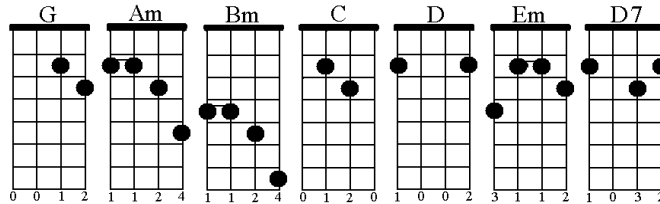


1 American Pie

G major, 138BPM



Verse 1:

G D Em
A long, long time ago,
Am C
I can still remember,
Em D
How that music used to make me smile
G D Em
And I knew if I had my chance,
Am C
That I could make those people dance,
Em C D
And maybe they'd be happy for a while.
Em Am
But February made me shiver,
Em Am
With every paper I'd deliver.
C G Am
Bad news on the doorstep;
C D
I couldn't take one more step

G D Em
I can't remember if I cried,
Am D
When I read about his widowed bride;
G D Em
But something touched me deep inside,
C D G
The day the music died.

Chorus:

G C G D
So, bye, bye, Miss American Pie
G C G D
Drove my Chevy to The Levee, but The Levee was dry
G C G D
And them good old boys were drinkin' whiskey in Rye
Em A7
Singin', This'll be the day that I die
Em
This'll be the day that I die.
D7/D7sus2/D7/D7sus2/D7

Additional lyrics

Verse 2:

Did you write the Book of Love?
And do you have faith in God above
If the Bible tells you so?
Do you believe in rock 'n' roll?
Can music save your mortal soul?
And can you teach me how to dance real slow?
Well, I know that you're in love with him
'Cause I saw you dancing in the gym
You both kicked off your shoes
Then I dig those rhythm and blues
I was a lonely teenage broncin' buck
With a pink carnation and a pickup truck
But I knew I was out of luck
The day the music died
I started singin',

Verse 3:

Now for ten years we've been on our own
And moss grows fat on a rollin' stone
But that's not how it used to be
When the jester sang for the king and queen
In a coat he borrowed from James Dean
And a voice that came from you and me
Oh, and while the king was looking down
The jester stole his thorny crown
The courtroom was adjourned
No verdict was returned
And while Lennon read a book on Marx
The quartet practiced in the park
And we sang dirges in the dark
The day the music died
We were singin',

Verse 4:

Helter Skelter in the summer swelter
The birds flew off with a fallout shelter
Eight miles high and fallin' fast
It landed foul on the grass
The players tried for a forward pass
With the jester on the sidelines in a cast
Now, the half-time air was sweet perfume
While the sergeants played a marching tune

We all got up to dance
Oh, but we never got the chance
'Cause the players tried to take the field
The marching band refused to yield
Do you recall what was revealed
The day the music died?
We started singin',

Verse 5:

Oh, and there we were, all in one place
A generation lost in space
With no time left to start again
So come on, Jack be nimble, Jack be quick
Jack Flash sat on a candlestick
'Cause fire is the devil's only friend
Oh, and as I watched him on the stage
My hands were clenched in fists of rage
No angel born in Hell
Could break that Satan's spell
And as the flames climbed high into the night
To light the sacrificial rite
I saw Satan laughing with delight
The day the music died
He was singin',

Verse 6:

I met a girl who sang the blues
And I asked her for some happy news
But she just smiled and turned away
I went down to the sacred store
Where I'd heard the music years before
But the man there said the music wouldn't play
And in the streets, the children screamed
The lovers cried and the poets dreamed
But not a word was spoken
The church bells all were broken
And the three men I admire most
The Father, Son, and the Holy Ghost
They caught the last train for the coast
The day the music died
And they were singin',